Day 11 Task 2 Experiment — Comparative Analysis

Three AI Tools, Three Very Different Outputs

Executive Summary

You asked the same question to **Perplexity**, **ChatGPT**, and **Claude** about Day 11 Task 2 structure. Each produced a valid but fundamentally different framework. This report analyzes their trade-offs and recommends a hybrid execution path.

Key finding: Perplexity optimized for measurable output. ChatGPT optimized for honest judgment. Claude (your current tool) can bridge both.

Framework Comparison

PERPLEXITY'S APPROACH

Stance: Scientific, metric-driven, concrete

What it does well:

- ✓ Explicit, trackable metrics (85% → 93.5% accuracy)
- ✓ Specific task definition (hyperparameter tuning on Iris/MNIST)
- ✓ Measurable stopping rule (10% improvement is testable)
- ✓ Reproducible: someone else could replicate this exactly
- ✓ Includes a tracking table (baseline, AI-assisted, % improvement, stop decision)

What it assumes:

- Your Task 2 is quantifiable (accuracy, time)
- You have a dataset ready to train on
- "Improvement" = metric goes up
- The task is technical/coding-adjacent

Risk:

- If Task 2 isn't ML/code, this framework breaks
- Metrics can lie (high accuracy ≠ solved the actual problem)

- Doesn't measure *cognitive load reduction*, only output quality

---

CHATGPT'S APPROACH

Stance: Behavioral, judgment-focused, honest about limitations

What it does well:

- ✓ Asks you to define frustration first (1–10 scale)
- ✓ Explicitly tests for "confident lying" — this is rare and valuable
- ✓ Measures cognitive load, not just speed
- ✓ The manual comparison step forces real trade-off analysis
- ✓ Catches hidden costs (time saved but verification effort increased)
- ✓ Produces portfolio-quality conclusions: "AI helped here because ___, failed because ___"

What it assumes:

- Your Task 2 is mentally exhausting (not just time-consuming)
- You can articulate *why* it's exhausting
- AI's real value is in thinking cost, not execution cost
- You will deliberately catch yourself lying about results

Risk:

- Less structured data collection
- No tracking table (harder to reference later)
- "Judgment" is harder to defend to skeptics

CLAUDE'S SYNTHESIS (What You Asked For)

Stance: Bridge between rigor and judgment

Your actual advantage:

- Can specify Task 2 in real time
- Can adjust metrics mid-experiment
- Can call out nonsense from Perplexity or ChatGPT
- Can document *process*, not just output

Side-by-Side Execution Model

Phase	Perplexity	ChatGPT	Recommended Hybrid
0:00–0:10	Not addressed	Re-anchor + finish sentence	Finish sentence: "This task wastes time because ___"
0:10–0:25	"Define failure boundary" (vague)	Define frustration (1–10) + baseline	Define BOTH: frustration level AND one concrete metric
0:25–1:20	Run ML tuning experiment	Run primary tool test, log surprises	Run task, use Claude as primary tool, real-time log
1:20–1:40	Track in table	Manual redo without AI (faster/sloppier)	Compare: your speed vs AI speed, your confidence vs AI confidence
1:40–2:00	Record % improvement	Write: what it did better, what it shouldn't touch, reuse?	**Write both**: hard metrics AND honest judgment

---

What Each Tool Got Right (and Why)

Perplexity's Strength

Perplexity understood that Day 11 is about *measurement*. The tracking table is the right artifact because:

- You can show it later as evidence
- It's harder to lie to yourself with numbers
- Others can replicate it

Use Perplexity's table if: Your Task 2 is quantifiable (code, design, analysis with clear metrics).

ChatGPT's Strength

ChatGPT understood that Day 11 is about *honesty*. The "confident lying" test is brilliant because:

- Most AI experiments hide this
- You need to know when the model bullshits convincingly
- Cognitive load is the real measure, not speed

Use ChatGPT's framework if: Your Task 2 is qualitative (writing, planning, decision-making, judgment calls).

The Hybrid Advantage

Neither tool is wrong. They're testing different hypotheses:

- Perplexity: *Can AI make measurable output better?*
- ChatGPT: *Does AI reduce thinking cost or just execution cost?*

Your hybrid experiment answers both:

1. Start with ChatGPT's frustration check (0:10–0:25)
2. Run the AI experiment with real-time logging (0:25–1:20)
3. If Task 2 is quantifiable, fill Perplexity's table (1:20–1:40)
4. End with ChatGPT's hard conclusions (1:40–2:00)

The Real Question Each Tool Misses

Both frameworks assume you *already know* what Task 2 is. You don't.

Critical 5-minute question before you start:

- What makes Task 2 the "second most mentally exhausting" task?
- Is it because of *complexity* (too many variables)?
- Is it because of *uncertainty* (feedback loops are slow)?
- Is it because of *repetition* (you do it constantly)?
- Is it because of *ambiguity* (success isn't clear)?

Your answer changes which framework fits better.

Example:

- Repetitive task + uncertainty? → Use Perplexity's table (measure consistency)
- Ambiguous task + mental drain? → Use ChatGPT's judgment framework (measure cognitive load)
- Both? → Use hybrid

Recommended Execution Order

0:00–0:05

Pick Task 2 and write: "*This task wastes time because [complexity/uncertainty/repetition/ambiguity]*"

0:05–0:20

Establish baseline:

- Time taken (or frustration level, or metric)
- Confidence level (1–10) in the result
- Where you currently add judgment

0:20–1:30

AI experiment:

- Use Claude (you're already here)
- Log in real time: surprises, confident lies, corrections needed
- Stop at measurable improvement (10% time, confidence, or metric)

1:30–1:50

Comparison:

- Redo without AI (faster, sloppier)
- Compare: time vs. cognitive load vs. error risk

1:50–2:00

Write conclusions (ChatGPT's format):

- One thing AI did better
- One thing it shouldn't touch
- Will you reuse this tomorrow? (yes/no)
- Why it worked / why it failed

Output: Tracking Table (Perplexity's format)

Dimension	Baseline	AI-Assisted	Improvement	Reusable?
Time	X min	Y min	Z%	Yes/No

Dimension	Baseline	AI-Assisted	Improvement	Reusable?
Confidence	X/10	Y/10	+Z	Yes/No
Error rate	X%	Y%	-Z%	Yes/No

Portfolio Signal

After Day 11, you'll have:

- **Quantitative proof** (Perplexity's table) of impact
- **Honest assessment** (ChatGPT's judgment) of trade-offs
- **Real execution data** (Claude's real-time log) of where AI actually struggled

This combination is worth more than any single tool's output because it shows you trust *neither* the metrics nor your intuition alone.

Next Step

Tell me: What is Task 2 specifically? (Not "AI engineering," but the actual task you'll tackle.)

Once you name it, I can:

1. Confirm which framework (quantitative vs. judgment-based) fits best
2. Help you set realistic baseline metrics
3. Be your logging partner during the 1:10 AI experiment window
4. Help you write the portfolio conclusions that matter